

Daily Economic Briefing

Wednesday, 26 August 2026 | Covers Tuesday 25 Aug 2026 full session, close, after-hours and overnight, through approx. 00:45 UTC 26 Aug (approx. 20:45 ET Tue) | Prepared for Alex

Status & corrections check — read first

- **Scheduler:** healthy — single fire, approx. 8 min after the 00:00 UTC slot, no duplicate, no gap. Fourth consecutive clean weekday fire.
- **Standing facts reverified fresh:** Fed Chair is still **Kevin Warsh** (Fed's own bio page, unchanged since 22 May 2026). The 2026 Jackson Hole Symposium is confirmed for **Thu–Sat, 27–29 Aug** — now one day away — with Warsh's first keynote as Chair expected Friday approx. 10am ET.¹
- **Correction to a prior figure:** edition 7 carried a Canada-tariff figure of approx. \$28bn, flagged then as unreconciled against an earlier \$20bn. This edition finds the \$28–30bn range in fact describes *Canada's retaliatory package*, not the US tariff itself — the US tariff on Canadian goods remains best-sourced at approx. \$20bn.²
- **Cross-vendor conflicts resolved this edition:** Nvidia's Tuesday close (\$213.05, against a stray \$225.30 options-reference figure), AMD's close (\$479.18, against a \$476.50 outlier), and Brent's Tuesday settlement (approx. \$87.06, against a higher mid-session \$89 cluster).
- **Administrative fix:** the scheduled task's own stored prompt still referenced the retired GitHub/Telegram delivery path (flagged in editions 6 and 7 without action) — corrected today at the trigger level so it stops recurring. Delivery is SendUserFile only, as Alex set on 17 Aug.

60-second read

- **Copper printed a fresh Comex all-time high** — a closing record \$6.7125/lb (+1.6%), intraday to \$6.7270 — breaking the 12 Aug record, as tariff-driven supply tightness and a London warehouse squeeze met a softer dollar; gold sat near a three-month high and Bitcoin touched a three-month high near \$81,100 in the same "debasement trade."³
- **The chip complex sharply reversed Monday's de-risking** into Wednesday's Nvidia print: Nvidia +2.19% to \$213.05 (snapping a seven-session slide), AMD +4.91% on a Raymond James upgrade to Strong Buy (target to \$641 from \$565), Micron +2.48% on a run of aggressive new targets (BofA reiterated \$1,550). Nvidia's options-implied move into tomorrow's after-the-close print has compressed to approx. 5.4% — below its own 12-quarter average of 7.4% and down from approx. 7.0% a week ago — reading as some complacency priced in ahead of the year's most-watched print.⁴
- **Dick's Sporting Goods cratered 30.68%**, the day's largest single-name move, after cutting full-year guidance on a loss-making Foot Locker integration and softening athletic-goods demand — dragging Nike, Lululemon and Academy Sports lower in sympathy and standing in some tension with the day's broader risk-on tone.⁵
- **Oil fell sharply** (WTI −3.3%, Brent −5.5%) as markets read Bessent's new Iran sanctions package as an economic substitute for military escalation, even as Hormuz shipping disruption and a fresh tanker attack near Oman continued. Falling oil plus an expanded Treasury bond-buyback program pulled the 10-year further off last Friday's 20-month high, to approx. 4.63–4.66%, even as Consumer Confidence hit a seven-month low and Richmond Fed manufacturing missed.⁶
- **The US–Canada trade fight escalated on both sides:** Canada announced 50% retaliatory tariffs on US steel, dairy and furniture effective 8 September, while Trump's threat to double US tariffs on Canadian autos and steel to 50% (effective 1 Jan 2027) still stands. USD/CAD held little-changed near 1.383 as trade-war-driven CAD weakness offset the tailwind of falling oil.²

1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow Jones	Nasdaq Comp	Russell 2000	VIX	10Y yield
7,677.28	53,577.40	26,151.30	3,010.02	15.45	approx. 4.65%
+0.32%	+0.30%	+0.66%	+0.50%	−2.52%	−2 to −7bp

All four major indices closed higher Tuesday, though gains were modest and narrower than they look: the Nasdaq's +0.66% and the broad chip-sector reversal were the session's real engine, while Dick's Sporting Goods' 30.68% collapse capped the Dow and weighed on consumer discretionary.⁷ The VIX eased to 15.45 even heading into Wednesday's Nvidia print, and copper's fresh all-time high pulled some risk-on tone into hard assets alongside equities.⁸ A Yahoo Finance page dated for Tuesday was found republishing Monday's index closes verbatim — a reminder of the date-confusion risk this desk checks for every session; it was discarded in favor of two independently agreeing sources (Associated Press wire syndication and Motley Fool's close recap).⁷

2. Equities and earnings

Dick's Sporting Goods — the day's largest single-name move

Dick's Sporting Goods closed −30.68% to \$124.31 on roughly 18x normal volume after cutting full-year adjusted EPS guidance to \$11.00–\$12.00, down from \$13.27–\$14.27.⁵ Adjusted EPS of \$3.53 and net sales of \$5.59bn both missed consensus (\$3.76 / approx. \$5.64bn). The DICK'S banner itself grew comps +4.9%, but the Foot Locker business acquired last year posted −3.6% comps and a \$31.9mn operating loss, and management flagged weaker athletic footwear and apparel demand alongside "increasingly promotional" conditions.⁵ The read-across pulled Nike −3%, Lululemon −4% and Academy Sports −5.80% to \$43.48 lower in sympathy.⁹

Chip complex reverses hard into Wednesday's Nvidia print

Nvidia closed +2.19% at \$213.05, snapping a seven-session losing streak that had taken it to \$208.48 Monday, ahead of Wednesday's 5pm ET after-market-close report (fiscal Q2, non-GAAP consensus approx. \$2.08–2.09 EPS on approx. \$91.7–92bn revenue, against company guidance of \$91bn plus/minus 2%).¹⁰ Raymond James reiterated Strong Buy and raised its target to \$352 from \$330.¹¹ AMD jumped 4.91% to \$479.18 on a separate Raymond James upgrade to Strong Buy, with the target lifted to \$641 from \$565 on the strength of the firm's server-CPU market-share thesis.¹² Micron rose 2.48% to \$932.97, reversing Monday's −5.8% slide, as New Street Research (\$1,250), BMO Capital Markets (initiating Outperform at \$1,300) and Bank of America (reiterating Buy at \$1,550) all pressed an "AI memory supercycle" thesis implying 34–66% upside from current levels — aggressive but

independently corroborated targets, not a data error.¹³ Marvell, which reports its own quarter Thursday after the close, rose approx. 5.7% as Rosenblatt (\$300, from \$240) and Susquehanna (\$265, from \$230) both positioned for a beat-and-raise.¹⁴

Elsewhere

Moderna rose more than 12% intraday (close unconfirmed) in a continuation of the mRNA-trade whipsaw that has run since last week's melanoma-trial headline, with no fresh clinical news behind Tuesday's move.¹⁵ Bitcoin touched a three-month intraday high near \$81,100 before settling approx. \$79,000–79,200, lifting Robinhood +6.06% to \$109.90 on the rally plus a Bernstein note projecting the prediction-markets industry (a business line Robinhood has expanded into) could scale toward \$1tn in volume by 2030.¹⁶ Boeing was awarded a US Air Force F-15 "Eagle Crest" production and sustainment framework worth up to \$131.23bn through 2037, covering foreign military sales to Japan, Israel, Saudi Arabia, South Korea, Singapore, Indonesia and Poland; shares were described as steadying, though an exact Tuesday close percentage could not be confirmed (Annex A).¹⁷ PDD Holdings' Q2 print (adjusted EPS beat, revenue a shade light) landed Monday rather than Tuesday and closed –1.5% to \$87.75 that session; carried here only for continuity.¹⁸

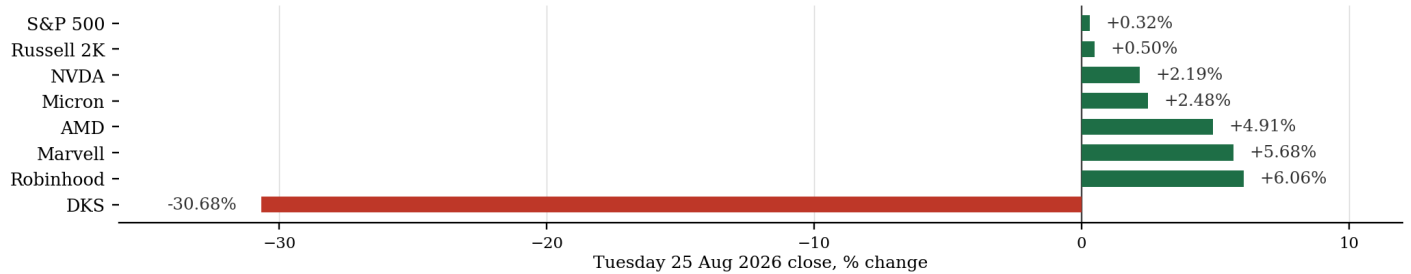


Chart 1 — Tuesday 25 Aug 2026 close, selected single-stock movers and index benchmarks (%). Source: see inline references above.

3. Macro, policy and rates

Conference Board Consumer Confidence fell to an 89.4 seven-month low in August, missing the approx. 90.2–90.3 consensus, with the Expectations sub-index dropping to 68.2 from 74.0 — deep below the 80 level historically associated with recession risk.¹⁹ Richmond Fed manufacturing slipped to +4 from +5, below the approx. +6–7 consensus.²⁰ The Case-Shiller national home-price index (June data) rose +1.5% year-on-year, its fourth straight month of acceleration, with the 20-city composite up +2.1% y/y; new home sales for July fell 10.5% month-on-month to a 607,000 annual rate, missing the approx. 630,000 consensus.²¹ No Fed speaker was confirmed on the record Tuesday (a Richmond Fed calendar reference to Barkin could not be corroborated against the Fed's own published schedule).²²

The 10-year yield eased a further 2–7bp to approx. 4.63–4.66%, extending its pullback from last Friday's 20-month high of 4.75%, driven primarily by the drop in oil prices and continued follow-through from Treasury's expanded long-bond buyback program rather than by Tuesday's soft data prints.⁶ Sept 16 FOMC odds on Polymarket were essentially unchanged at 67% hold / 33% hike / approx. 1% cut, little moved by the weaker confidence and manufacturing readings.²³

Canada announced retaliatory tariffs effective 8 September — 50% duties on US steel, furniture and dairy, plus cheese, paper, pulp and farm equipment — after last-minute talks that would have cut US steel/aluminum tariffs to 25% and auto tariffs to 15% collapsed.² That sits alongside Trump's Monday threat to double the US tariff on Canadian autos and steel to 50% effective 1 Jan 2027, on top of the 50% US tariff on approx. \$20bn of Canadian goods already in effect since 22 Aug.²⁴ Separately, Treasury Secretary Bessent's Monday-announced Iran sanctions program ("Operation Economic Outcast" — expanded secondary sanctions on financial and trade networks moving Iranian oil through the UAE, Hong Kong, China, Singapore, Switzerland and Europe) drew a muted market reaction Tuesday, read as an economic-track measure rather than one raising near-term supply-disruption risk — the principal reason oil fell rather than rose on the news.²⁵

4. Commodities and FX

WTI settled approx. \$82.2–82.4/bbl (–3.1% to –3.3%) and Brent approx. \$87.06 (–5.5%), reversing an early-session bounce after Bessent's Iran sanctions were read as lowering near-term war-premium risk, even as a tanker was struck by hostile fire off Oman and Hormuz transit stayed near multi-month lows.²⁵ Gold traded in a \$4,677–4,720 range (vendor snapshots only; no clean Comex settlement was obtainable), near a three-month high on dollar softness and continued Treasury buyback follow-through; silver eased to approx. \$68.0–69.0 on profit-taking after testing above \$70 last week.²⁶ Copper set a fresh Comex all-time high — \$6.7125/lb closing (+1.6%), \$6.7270 intraday (+1.8%) — surpassing the 12 Aug record of \$6.7140, driven by tariff-linked supply tightness and a London warehouse squeeze pulling metal toward Comex.³ The dollar index eased to approx. 98.90 (–0.10%); USD/CAD held little-changed at approx. 1.3832 as trade-war-driven CAD weakness offset the tailwind from falling oil, while swaps continued to price approx. 84% odds of a September BoJ hike (up from approx. 80% last week) on above-target Japanese inflation and yen weakness near 159.²⁷

Commodity / FX	Tue 25 Aug	Change	Note
WTI crude	approx. \$82.30	–3.3%	Settlement, converged multi-source
Brent crude	approx. \$87.06	–5.5%	TradingEconomics; resolved vs. higher cluster
Nat gas (Henry Hub)	n/a	n/a	Unavailable, see Annex A
Gold (Comex Dec)	\$4,677–4,720	approx. +0.4%	Vendor snapshots only, no clean settle
Silver (Comex)	\$68.0–69.0	softer	Vendor snapshots only
Copper (Comex)	\$6.7125 (close)	+1.6%	Fresh all-time closing high
Platinum	n/a	n/a	Unavailable, see Annex A

DXY	approx. 98.90	-0.10%	TradingEconomics
EUR/USD	approx. 1.167	n/a	Tuesday close not separately confirmed
USD/JPY	approx. 159.3	n/a	European-session snapshot
GBP/USD	approx. 1.364	n/a	Tuesday close not separately confirmed
USD/CAD	1.3832	-0.08%	TradingEconomics, matches late-session read
USD/MXN	n/a	n/a	Unavailable, see Annex A

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The VIX closed 15.45, down 2.52% from Monday's 15.85, with VIX3M at approx. 18.21 (single-sourced) putting the VIX/VIX3M ratio at approx. 0.848 — contango, deepening modestly.²⁸ VVIX printed approx. 86.22 (single-sourced; a base-value conflict versus this desk's own Monday figure means a day-over-day comparison isn't reliable this edition).²⁸ Nvidia's options-implied move into Wednesday's print has compressed to approx. 5.4% (ORATS, via a dated and named citation), down from approx. 6.17% Monday and approx. 7.0% a week ago, and now sits below the stock's own 12-quarter average implied move of 7.4% against a 12-quarter average realized move of just 2.8% — one options desk (SpotGamma) framed this broadly as a volatility-compression environment (SPY implied-vol rank cited at just 14%) heading into a very earnings- and Jackson-Hole-heavy week.²⁹ The same source named the 195-strike puts and 220-strike calls as Nvidia's largest concentrated options positions, with dealer gamma dynamics that could support the stock on a pullback and amplify a rally to the upside — directional color from a credible named source, not verified exchange-level gamma data.²⁹

No new CFTC Commitment of Traders data fell in this window; the next release (data as of Tue 25 Aug) is due Friday 28 Aug per the CFTC's own schedule.³⁰ SOFR's most recent print was 3.65% (Monday 24 Aug, published with the standard one-day lag), flat versus Friday.³¹ ON RRP take-up rose to \$0.380bn Monday from \$0.200bn Friday, still minimal in absolute terms; the award rate is inferred flat at 3.50% absent any intervening FOMC action, but was not freshly observed this session (Annex A).³¹ The Fed's H.4.1 balance sheet remains at week-ended-19-Aug levels (reserves approx. \$2.935tn, TGA approx. \$953.6bn, total assets approx. \$6.746tn); the next release is due Thursday 27 Aug.³²

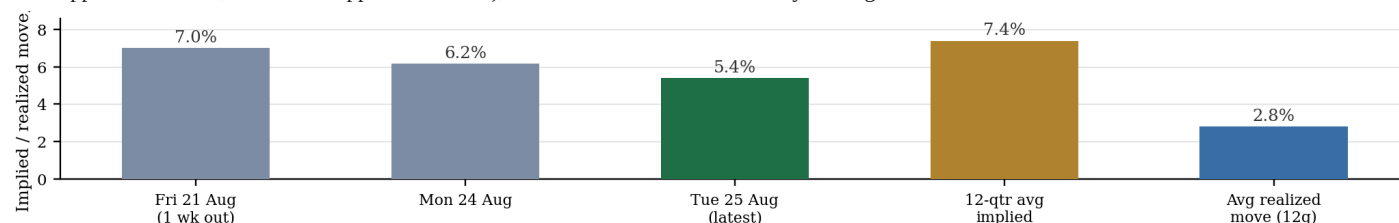


Chart 2 — Nvidia options-implied move into the Wednesday 26 Aug print, compressing day-over-day, vs. 12-quarter historical average implied and realized moves. Source: ORATS/Yahoo Finance, TipRanks, Barchart.

6. The day ahead

Wednesday 26 August brings Q2 GDP second estimate (consensus approx. +1.5%), July durable goods orders (approx. +0.4%) and July PCE/core PCE (core approx. +0.2% m/m, approx. 3.2–3.3% y/y) — all at 8:30am ET — ahead of the week's dominant catalyst: Nvidia reports fiscal Q2 results after the close, with the earnings call at 5pm ET.³³

Date	Event	Consensus / detail
Wed 26 Aug	Q2 GDP, 2nd estimate	approx. +1.5% (unchanged from advance)
Wed 26 Aug	July durable goods orders	approx. +0.4% m/m
Wed 26 Aug	July PCE / core PCE	Core approx. +0.2% m/m, approx. 3.2–3.3% y/y
Wed 26 Aug, 5pm ET	Nvidia (NVDA) Q2 FY27 earnings	Cons. approx. \$2.08–2.09 EPS / approx. \$91.7–92bn rev.
Thu 27 Aug	Jackson Hole Symposium opens (through Sat 29)	Theme: financial innovation, payments and policy
Thu 27 Aug	Jobless claims	Cons. approx. 207K
Thu 27 Aug, AMC	Marvell (MRVL) earnings	Positioned for beat-and-raise per sell-side
Thu 27 Aug	Fed H.4.1 balance sheet	Week ended 26 Aug data
Fri 28 Aug, approx. 10am ET	Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote	First as Chair; genuinely upcoming, verify fresh
Fri 28 Aug	CFTC CoT data (as of Tue 25 Aug)	Standard Friday release

Sector setup we take into Wednesday

- Semiconductors and AI-infrastructure names go into Nvidia's print with implied volatility unusually compressed relative to history — a setup that raises the odds of an outsized post-print reaction in either direction rather than a muted one.
- Consumer discretionary carries a fresh warning from Dick's Sporting Goods on the health of the athletic-goods consumer, even as the broader tape stayed risk-on — a divergence worth watching in Thursday's and Friday's retail-adjacent prints.
- Rate-sensitive and hard-asset trades (gold, copper, long-duration equities) are all leaning on the same two supports — a softer dollar and Treasury's buyback-driven yield relief — that could reverse quickly if Wednesday's PCE print runs hot.
- Trade-policy risk (US–Canada) and geopolitical risk (Iran/Hormuz) are both live and moving in opposite directions for oil and the Canadian dollar simultaneously — a genuine two-sided setup into month-end.

Annex A — Could not be verified this edition

- Henry Hub natural gas Tuesday settlement — no dated source found; next EIA storage report due Thu 27 Aug.
- Platinum Tuesday price — no dated, sourceable figure found.
- Gold and silver Tuesday closes — vendor snapshots only; no exchange-confirmed Comex settlement retrieved.
- EUR/USD and GBP/USD Tuesday closes — not separately confirmed from Monday's baseline levels.
- USD/MXN Tuesday level — no dated source found.
- VIX3M and VVIX — both single-sourced; a base-value conflict on Monday's VVIX (86.27 vs. 88.64 across sources) means the day-over-day VVIX change is unreliable this edition.
- ON RRP award rate for Tuesday specifically — inferred flat at 3.50% (no intervening FOMC action) rather than freshly observed.
- SOFR — sourced from two secondary aggregators (sofrate.com, global-rates.com); the New York Fed's own reference-rates page did not return a usable data table this session.
- Boeing's exact Tuesday close and percentage change — only "steadying near \$210" qualitative color was found alongside the F-15 contract news.
- Moderna's exact Tuesday close and percentage change — only an intraday "+12%+" read was sourced; no confirmed close.
- Strategy Inc (MSTR) Tuesday close — could not be confirmed despite the broader Bitcoin/crypto-proxy rally.
- A same-day 11-sector GICS closing table and confirmed closing market breadth — not obtainable, consistent with prior editions.
- MOVE index, CBOE daily put/call ratio, VIX9D/VIX6M numeric closes, exchange-confirmed dealer gamma/GEX, official CME/ICE settlement prices, and official CME FedWatch probabilities — all persistently unavailable free, per this desk's standing experience.
- Official Treasury.gov par yield curve for the Tuesday session — not posted by cutoff; secondary market levels (TradingEconomics, Schwab) used instead and disclosed as such.
- A confirmed on-the-record Fed speaker for Tuesday 25 Aug — a Richmond Fed calendar reference to President Barkin could not be corroborated against the Fed's own published schedule.

Annex B — Sources

1. Federal Reserve, Warsh bio page; Kansas City Fed, Jackson Hole Symposium FAQ page.	12. Yahoo/CA Finance, AMD trending-ticker recap; TS2.tech, "AMD stock jumps 4% as Raymond James sees \$201 billion server CPU market."	24. PBS NewsHour, "What to know about Trump's 50% tariffs on Canadian goods"; Al Jazeera, "US imposes 50% tariffs on \$20bn worth of Canadian goods"; Fox Business, Canada auto/steel tariff-doubling report.
2. Bloomberg, "Canada's Carney Matches Trump Tariffs With 50% Tax on US Steel, Furniture, Dairy," 25 Aug 2026; CBC News, Canada retaliatory tariff figure; NBC News.	13. StartupHub.ai AI Stocks Daily, 25 Aug 2026 (MU close); TheStreet (New Street Research, BMO targets); QZ.com and TipRanks (Bank of America target).	25. Axios, "Bessent D-Day Iran secondary sanctions"; CNBC, "Oil hits one-week low as investors shrug off Iran sanctions," 25 Aug 2026; TechTimes, "Iran Oil Prices Fall 3% on De-Escalation Bet."
3. Mining.com, "Copper price touches fresh Comex record," 25 Aug 2026; BeInCrypto, "Copper Hits Highest Close in History," 25 Aug 2026.	14. Motley Fool, "Why Marvell Technology Stock Is Rocketing Higher," 25 Aug 2026.	26. Yahoo Finance, gold and silver price recaps, 25 Aug 2026; Kitco PM Report (title/date confirmed via search, full text not independently retrieved).
4. StockAnalysis.com, NVDA price history; StartupHub.ai AI Stocks Daily, 25 Aug 2026; Yahoo Finance/ORATS, "Nvidia shares set for \$280 billion price swing," 25 Aug 2026.	15. Motley Fool, "Stock Market Midday, Aug. 25: Tech Stocks Rebound and Dick's Sporting Goods Plummets."	27. TradingEconomics, DXY and USD/CAD; FXStreet, USD/JPY and USD/CAD forecasts, 25 Aug 2026; Yahoo Finance, "Japan's Inflation Print Just Made a September BOJ Hike Harder to Avoid."
5. StockTitan, Dick's Sporting Goods Q2 press release extract; GuruFocus earnings recap; StockAnalysis.com DKS overview.	16. Yahoo Finance, "Bitcoin and Ethereum prices today, Tuesday, August 25, 2026"; CryptoTimes, "Robinhood Stock (HOOD) Rises 6% as Prediction Markets Draw Wall Street."	28. Yahoo Finance, ^VIX historical data; thetrading.tools VIX Term Structure Tracker; Investing.com, CBOE VVIX historical data.
6. TradingEconomics, US government bond yields; Investing.com "Morning Bid" column, 25 Aug 2026.	17. Ad-hoc-news.de, "Boeing Stock Steadies as \$131.23 Billion F-15 Deal Expands Defense Backlog."	29. Yahoo Finance/ORATS, "Nvidia shares set for \$280 billion price swing," 25 Aug 2026; Benzinga, "Earnings Volatility Watch: Nvidia Week"; SpotGamma Substack, "Volatility Has Compressed. What Happens Next?"
7. Motley Fool, "Stock Market Today, Aug. 25," close recap; The Epoch Times / AP wire syndication, "How major US stock indexes fared, Aug. 25."	18. Yahoo Finance, "PDD Holdings Shares Rise After Q2 Earnings Beat"; Motley Fool, "Why PDD Holdings Stock Slumped Today," 24 Aug 2026.	30. CFTC, Commitments of Traders release schedule.
8. Yahoo Finance, ^VIX historical data; thetrading.tools, VIX Term Structure Tracker, 25 Aug 2026.	19. InvestingLive, US Conference Board release recap; PR Newswire, Conference Board press release; Bloomberg, "US Consumer Confidence Falls," 25 Aug 2026.	31. sofrate.com; global-rates.com SOFR historical data; FRED, RRPONTSYD series.
9. 24/7 Wall St., "Dick's Sporting Goods Tumbles... Lululemon Drops 4%, Nike Declines 3%," 25 Aug 2026.	20. TradingEconomics, Richmond Fed Manufacturing Index.	32. Federal Reserve, H.4.1 current release and release-dates schedule.
10. NVIDIA Newsroom, Q2 FY2027 conference-call press release; TechTimes, NVDA earnings/PCE preview.	21. TradingView/PR Newswire, S&P Cotality Case-Shiller release; Calculated Risk, "New Home Sales Decrease to 607,000"; HousingWire, new-home-sales recap.	33. Bureau of Economic Analysis, news release schedule; Investing.com, Wednesday economic calendar; NVIDIA Newsroom, conference-call press release.
11. MarketBeat, "Nvidia Price Target Raised to \$352 at Raymond James," 25 Aug 2026.	22. Federal Reserve, official events calendar, August 2026.	
	23. Polymarket, "Fed Decision in September?" market, accessed 25 Aug 2026.	

Method: figures are drawn from named public sources with inline numbered references to Annex B; where sources disagreed the more authoritative source was used and the disagreement disclosed, or the figure was reported as a range. Nothing is estimated, inferred, or filled from memory — items that could not be verified from a live source appear in Annex A rather than as a number. This briefing is market-wide commentary, not investment advice, and carries no portfolio or holdings view.